



WISAM HASHLAMOUN Anadoli

IRAN FIRES MISSILES AT ISRAEL

A projectile streaks across the night sky, seen from the West Bank city of Hebron, as the Islamic Republic launches its first bombardment of Israel since a fragile ceasefire took effect in early April. **WORLD, A2**

Security at World Cup poses daunting challenge

Event across three nations kicks off this week, with 48 teams and 104 matches.

By Jake Offenhartz, Michael R. Sisak and Rebecca Santana

NEW YORK — The World Cup, a 48-team, 104-match behemoth kicking off this week in Los Angeles and across 15 other cities in the United States, Mexico and Canada, presents an unprecedented security challenge, with more countries, games and a larger footprint than ever before.

It also comes against the backdrop of the U.S. and Israel's war with Iran, mounting political violence in President Trump's orbit and growing fears of artificial intelligence-fueled disruptions, creating a complex threat environment for authorities.

Overseeing the sprawling security apparatus is a legion of federal agencies, state and local police departments and private entities. Their responsibilities include securing stadiums and fan zones, escorting teams and protecting dignitaries.

Their tools include hunter drones that can shoot nets over objects in restricted airspace, bag-inspecting robot dogs, giant X-ray trucks and thousands of AI-powered cameras trained on public spaces soon to be thronged by fans.

In the U.S., it's "78 Super Bowls over 39 days," said Andrew Giuliani, executive director of Trump's World Cup task force, which is overseeing the multiagency effort.

"There's never been a summer like this in American history from a security angle," said Giuliani, son of former New York City Mayor Rudolph W. Giuliani. "We're as prepared as we can be."

Collaborative effort among agencies

The tournament has the same high-level federal security designation as the Super Bowl, just below a presidential inauguration or a national political convention, ensuring federal, state and local coordination. It coincides with other major events linked to the 250th anniversary of America's founding.

So far, Giuliani said, there are no credible threats.

The Department of Homeland Security, focused on Trump's immigration enforcement crackdown and with a funding lapse only re-

[See Security, A7]

Trump's race against time for his pet projects

Efforts to fast-track D.C. cityscape revamp ahead of legal challenges have raised costs and risks

By Michael Wilner and Ana Ceballos

WASHINGTON — A relentless push by President Trump to reshape Washington's cityscape is facing mounting resistance, threatening a slate of transformative monuments intended to cement his legacy in the nation's capital.

Eager to see his projects completed before leaving office, Trump has responded to growing legal and political obstacles by pushing ahead, attempting to force approvals through faster than opponents can challenge them. But the scramble to fast-track construction has inflated their costs for taxpayers, imperiling his plans and amplifying his political risks as the midterm elections approach.

Urban design has become a preoccupation for Trump since the start of his

second term. Cranes dot the skyline of the city, and construction fences block access to many of its most cherished parks and venues less than a month before the nation celebrates 250 years since its founding on July 4.

Government lawyers are defending the president's use of the wrecking ball, arguing in court that he has unfettered power to build and destroy. Should he ever choose to tear down the Statue of Liberty, the Justice Department told a judge Friday, no one could stop him.

Yet a recent series of legal setbacks, as well as increasing Republican opposition on Capitol Hill, have cast doubt on the fate of his most lavish designs, including

[See Projects, A5]

'I didn't want to work for anybody'

Tracing Byron Allen's journey from comedian to media mogul

By Stacy Perman



JASON ARMOND Los Angeles Times

BYRON ALLEN'S "Comics Unleashed" took over Stephen Colbert's "Late Show" time slot on CBS.

When CBS announced that it planned to outsource the hallowed "Late Show" slot occupied by Stephen Colbert and David Letterman before him to "Comics Unleashed," the syndicated, low-budget talk show with stand-ups riffing on their routines, many saw politics at play.

But the show's host and producer, comic-turned-mogul Byron Allen, saw the math. Once a cultural touchstone, late-night television has seen its prominence erode greatly over the years with viewers and advertising dollars shifting away from broadcast TV to streaming.

"I said, 'Look guys, you're spending a small fortune on late night,'" recalled Allen, who estimated that the programming was costing the network more than \$200 million. He offered it a solution.

His company, the Los Angeles-based Allen Media Group, would pay \$15 million for the airtime to run "Comics Unleashed," which previously aired after "The Late Show," while keeping most of the advertising time on

[See Allen, A10]

The flip side of vinyl records revival

Labels, groups team up to lessen environmental toll

By Julius Miller

Sorry to rain on your all-analog parade.

It's no secret that vinyl records' resurgence has hit a new plateau, outselling CDs for the first time since 1987 as of 2022, according to a report from the Recording Industry Assn. of America. Three years later, its year-end report flaunts another statistic: Vinyl record sales surpassed \$1 billion in 2025 — the first time since 1983.

But there's an inevitable downside to anything that's made of ancient organic matter. Modern vinyl re-

records are crafted with PVC resin, which makes up more than 75% of an average disk. The synthetic polymer itself is made of chlorine and fossil-fuel-derived feedstock.

To put its harm in perspective, a first-of-its-kind report from Vinyl Alliance, published in June 2024, found that 50% of a record's carbon emissions come from this resin. The carbon footprint of a single LP was estimated to be roughly equal to the pollution a gas-powered vehicle emits over a three-mile trip. It adds up quick, considering that 46.8 million new records were sold last year.

Thankfully, it's not all grim.

Organizations like Music Declares Emergency and the Music Climate Pact initiative are coming together to address the issue. A campaign by the groups — in collaboration with record labels and distribution teams at Secretly Group, Excelsior Music, Warp Records, Ninja Tune and Beggars Group — features titles pressed on 100% reclaimed material.

The release, set in tandem with World Environment Day last week, boasts marquee titles such as Elli-

[See Records, A8]

Raman surges past Pratt in mayor contest

City Council member pulls ahead of reality TV star, closing in on a runoff against Bass.

By David Zahniser and Noah Goldberg

Los Angeles City Councilmember Nithya Raman surged past reality television personality Spencer Pratt in the city's mayoral primary election Sunday, capping off a five-day turnaround after she fell behind Pratt on election night.

Raman now sits in second place with Pratt in third, according to the latest vote count from the Los Angeles Registrar-Recorder. Raman had 27.1% of the votes counted so far, and Pratt had 26.7%.

Both are vying to compete in a Nov. 3 runoff against Mayor Karen Bass, who garnered 34.7% of the vote as of Sunday, and who the Associated Press already determined has quali-

fied for the runoff.

"We are encouraged by the latest vote count and remain grateful to the thousands of Angelenos who have powered this campaign," Raman said in a statement issued by her campaign.

Bass campaign spokesman Alex Stack said that if Raman maintains that position, the mayor would "look forward to winning a contest against an opponent who allows encampments near schools and fights against hiring more cops, yet is MIA on saving Hollywood jobs and fighting back when ICE invades L.A."

Mail-in ballots with a June 2 election day postmark will continue to be accepted by county election officials through Tuesday.

Pratt took an early lead over Raman on election night, but Raman's numbers improved steadily as mail-in ballots were counted, leading political observers to begin predicting over the weekend that she would eventu-

[See Mayor, A6]

'CROOKED' CLAIM: Trump again baselessly alleges vote fraud, then halts interview. **CALIFORNIA, B3**

LAPD report calls one unit a 'gang'

New case in South L.A. reinforces concerns over 'ghost stops' seen in Valley.

By Libor Jany

The LAPD internal investigation leveled a troubling allegation: Officers in a specialized unit tasked with combating street gangs had themselves behaved like a gang.

In 2023, officers in the San Fernando Valley were accused of making dozens of improper traffic stops and attempting to hide their actions from their supervisors by switching off their body cameras.

When confronted by Internal Affairs detectives, according to the findings of a months-long probe, officers in the Valley's "gang enforcement detail" said they were engaged in a "gun hunting competition," with each firearm-related arrest tracked on a whiteboard in their office. Cops with the most seizures would pose for pictures with a pro-wrestling-style

championship belt that had "Mission GED Pistoleros" emblazoned on the buckle.

The Internal Affairs report, like most records around police discipline, was kept confidential by the LAPD, and its findings have not previously been made public. The report said the Valley unit was a "law enforcement gang."

Allegations of deputy gangs operating within the Los Angeles County Sheriff's Department have been well documented, but this is the first known instance of the LAPD using the label on its own officers. California state law defines a "law enforcement gang" as a group of officers "who engage in a pattern of on-duty behavior that intentionally violates the law or fundamental principles of professional policing."

LAPD leaders said at the time that the problems were confined to that division. But a new case involving similar allegations against anti-gang officers operating out of South L.A.'s 77th Street patrol area has reignited questions about

[See LAPD, A6]



LAURA WOLFF For The Times

USC FALLS SHORT

Two outs away from reaching their first College World Series in 25 years, the Trojans lose 4-3 on a walk-off hit by North Carolina. **SPORTS, D1**

Ex-U.S. Sen. Bob Packwood dies

Moderate Republican of Oregon was tainted late in his career by a sexual harassment scandal. **NATION, A6**

Weather

Low clouds, sun. L.A. Basin: 78/60. **B5**

Business **A9**
Opinion Voices **A11**

James Conlon's fond farewell

L.A. Opera's inventive "Magic Flute" is a fitting swan song for its music director. **ENTERTAINMENT, E1**

For the latest news, go to **latimes.com**.

